

PIPRA Solutions Solution Engineer - What to Learn

MUST Learn (Class A keywords with no direct project experience)

- **Java with Spring Boot** – your backend production experience is entirely Node.js/Express; Java + Spring Boot is a real language and framework switch (JD lists it as preferred, alongside Node.js as an alternative). Bridge from Express: Spring Boot controllers $\approx$ Express route handlers, Spring's dependency injection $\approx$ a more formalized version of the module patterns you already use. Build one small REST API with Spring Boot + Spring Data JPA to have a concrete Java project.
- **Hibernate/JPA** – Java's ORM layer, the equivalent role to Prisma (which you use across multiple projects). Once you understand Spring Boot basics, JPA entities and repositories should map fairly directly onto your existing ORM mental model.
- **Flutter** – your mobile experience is React Native, not Flutter (Dart). Bridge from React Native: both are cross-platform frameworks with a widget/component tree and hot reload – React components $\approx$ Flutter widgets. Build one small Flutter app to get comfortable with Dart syntax and StatefulWidget vs. StatelessWidget before an interview, since this JD lists Flutter alongside React.js for the frontend/mobile layer.

GOOD to Learn (strengthens the application, not blocking)

- **Angular** – listed as a "preferred" exposure alongside Node.js, lower priority than Java/Spring Boot since your React skills are much stronger and likely the more relevant frontend option in practice.
- **Application security concepts, applied** – the JD explicitly names "application security concepts." You have practical exposure (Clerk/JWT auth across projects, IDOR/security findings from your own code audits), but review OWASP Top 10 basics (injection, broken auth, IDOR) to speak to this confidently and generally, not just via the specific tools you've used.
- **Offline-capable / mobile-first development** – you have some offline-persistence experience (Realm at Edfora); deepen this if the role leans mobile, since it's called out as a preferred skill.

Fast-Ramp Note

Your core strengths (React.js, Node.js, REST API design, PostgreSQL/MySQL, AWS) cover the "Node.js" backend path and the full frontend/API-integration side of this JD directly. The real gap is the Java/Spring Boot path, which the JD explicitly prefers – build one small Spring Boot project before interviewing, since "Java frameworks" is this JD's headline backend requirement even though Node.js is listed as an accepted alternative.